



IS THIS SAFE?

You pack a cooler with freshly cooked chicken, keep it chilled below 40°F with ice packs during a summer picnic, and consume all leftovers within 2 hours of serving.



IS THIS SAFE?

You find a can of home-canned green beans with a bulging lid and a foul odor inside the jar after storage at room temperature for several months.



IS THIS SAFE?

You plan to can tomato salsa at home without adding lemon juice or citric acid, using a boiling water bath canner at your local altitude of 4000 feet.



IS THIS SAFE?

You have selected fresh, firm peaches and prepared them according to a tested recipe by washing, peeling, and slicing. You packed them into clean, hot Mason jars with the recommended headspace and processed them in a boiling water canner for the exact time specified in the recipe, adjusting for your altitude.



IS THIS SAFE?

You decided to can underripe plums without adding any acid or adjusting the boiling water canner processing time. You packed the fruit raw into jars without preheating or hot packing and processed them for less time than recommended in your source recipe.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You want to can pear halves at 3,000 feet altitude. The recipe you found shows times for sea level but lacks altitude processing time adjustments. You prepare the jars and pears as directed but are unsure if processing at sea level times is enough.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You followed a tested salsa recipe that included adding bottled lemon juice to your tomatoes and onions, processed the jars in a boiling water canner for the full 15 minutes at your local altitude, and used fresh, firm Roma tomatoes.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You canned salsa using fresh tomatoes but did not add any bottled lemon juice or vinegar, and processed the jars in a boiling water canner for only 5 minutes instead of the recommended 15.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You made salsa with fresh garden tomatoes and peppers using your own original recipe that does not specify vinegar or bottled lemon juice amounts, then processed it in a boiling water canner for 15 minutes at sea level.

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IS THIS SAFE?

Sarah uses a tested USDA recipe to pressure can green beans in quart jars. She maintains correct headspace, adjusts processing time for her 3,000 feet altitude, and ensures her pressure canner's gauge is accurate before starting.



IS THIS SAFE?

Tom fills quart jars with leftover spaghetti sauce with meat, puts on lids, and processes them in a boiling water canner for 20 minutes, then stores them at room temperature without refrigeration.



IS THIS SAFE?

Linda stores homemade garlic-in-oil mixtures at room temperature, but she only followed some acidification steps and is unsure if the product is sufficiently acidified to prevent botulism.

PICKLING

Adults

PK-A01



IS THIS SAFE?

A home cook follows a tested pickling recipe exactly, using 5% vinegar, packing vegetables in clean Mason jars with proper headspace, and processing in a boiling water canner for the recommended time based on altitude.

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PICKLING

Adults

PK-A02



IS THIS SAFE?

Someone uses homemade vinegar of uncertain acidity to make pickles and does not adjust the recipe's vinegar amount or processing time. The jars are sealed without being processed in boiling water or a pressure canner.

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PICKLING

Adults

PK-A03



IS THIS SAFE?

A home preserver intends to make quick pickles but is unsure whether they should boil the jars in a water bath after packing with vinegar and vegetables stored at 4,000 feet elevation.

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IS THIS SAFE?

You follow a tested low-sugar jam recipe that uses low-methoxyl pectin. After cooking, you process the jars in a boiling water bath canner for 10 minutes. You refrigerate the jam after opening.



IS THIS SAFE?

You opened a jar of jelly stored at room temperature and noticed a fuzzy mold growth on the surface. You carefully scraped off the mold and planned to eat the jelly as usual.

Sort it: **SAFE** · NOT SAFE · IT DEPENDS



IS THIS SAFE?

You made a pepper jelly using a recipe without specifying added acid. You processed the jelly in a boiling water bath canner for the usual recommended time. You wonder if it's safe to store at room temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

Marcy freezes a batch of homemade vegetable soup immediately after cooking, cooling it quickly in an ice bath before portioning and placing it in airtight containers in her freezer held at 0°F (-18°C). She always labels the containers with the date and plans to use them within 3 months.



IS THIS SAFE?

Tom stores canned vegetables in his unheated garage over winter where temperatures drop below 30°F. He notices some cans have bulging lids but thaws them and uses the contents without further inspection or heating.



IS THIS SAFE?

Lena thawed frozen green beans that had partially warmed to 45°F during a power outage. She wonders if she can safely refreeze or cook them.



IS THIS SAFE?

You use a food dehydrator that maintains a steady temperature of 145°F to dry beef jerky. You always check the internal temperature of the dehydrator with an accurate thermometer before starting, ensuring it reaches the required temperature.



IS THIS SAFE?

You smoke fish at home but do not monitor the temperature or time during the smoking process. You finish when the fish looks dried without measuring internal temperature or following any tested recipe.



IS THIS SAFE?

You are drying tomatoes using a homemade solar dryer on your covered porch. You are unsure if the air temperature consistently reaches the recommended drying temperature and you don't know the altitude of your location.